

Psalms 9

God the Righteous Judge

The Lord also will be a refuge for the oppressed
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 I will praise thee, O LORD, with my whole heart; I will shew forth all thy marvellous works.
- 2 I will be glad and rejoice in thee: I will sing praise to thy name, O thou most High.
- 3 When mine enemies are turned back, they shall fall and perish at thy presence.
- 4 For thou hast maintained my right and my cause; thou satest in the throne judging right.
- 5 Thou hast rebuked the heathen, thou hast destroyed the wicked, thou hast put out their name for ever and ever.
- 6 O thou enemy, destructions are come to a perpetual end: and thou hast destroyed cities; their memorial is perished with them.
- 7 But the LORD shall endure for ever: he hath prepared his throne for judgment.
- 8 And he shall judge the world in righteousness, he shall minister judgment to the people in uprightness.
- 9 The LORD also will be a refuge for the oppressed, a refuge in times of trouble.
- 10 And they that know thy name will put their trust in thee: for thou, LORD, hast not forsaken them that seek thee.
- 11 Sing praises to the LORD, which dwelleth in Zion: declare among the people his doings.
- 12 When he maketh inquisition for blood, he remembereth them: he forgetteth not the cry of the humble.
- 13 Have mercy upon me, O LORD; consider my trouble which I suffer of them that hate me, thou that liftest me up from the gates of death:
- 14 That I may shew forth all thy praise in the gates of the daughter of Zion: I will rejoice in thy salvation.
- 15 The heathen are sunk down in the pit that they made: in the net which they hid is their own foot taken.
- 16 The LORD is known by the judgment which he executeth: the wicked is snared in the work of his own hands. Higgsaion. Selah.
- 17 The wicked shall be turned into hell, and all the nations that forget God.
- 18 For the needy shall not alway be forgotten: the expectation of the poor shall not perish for ever.
- 19 Arise, O LORD; let not man prevail: let the heathen be judged in thy sight.
- 20 Put them in fear, O LORD: that the nations may know themselves to be but men. Selah.

2 · CONTEXT

A thanksgiving and judgment psalm of David (often linked with Psalm 10 in Hebrew tradition as a partial acrostic). It celebrates God's just rule, refuge for the oppressed, and the self-defeat of the wicked. Henry stresses wholehearted praise and God's unfailing memory of the humble's cry.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-6

Wholehearted praise for marvelous works. Enemies fall at God's presence; He maintains the psalmist's cause, rebukes nations, blots out the wicked's name. Human memorials perish; God's justice endures.

Verse 7-10

The Lord sits enthroned forever for judgment in righteousness. He is a refuge for the oppressed in trouble. Those who know His name trust Him; He does not forsake seekers.

Verse 11-14

Public praise in Zion and among the peoples. God remembers bloodshed and the cry of the humble. Personal plea: mercy from haters, lifted from death's gates, to recount praise in Zion.

Verse 15-20

The nations sink in their own pit and net. The Lord is known by His judgments; the wicked are snared by their hands. The wicked and forgetful nations face ruin; the needy will not be forever forgotten. Prayer: arise, let nations know they are but men.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

God’s throne means righteous judgment and real refuge. Oppressors fall into their own traps; the poor’s hope is not naive. Knowing God’s name produces trust; forgetting God is deadly for nations and persons.

Application for life today.

Praise with your “whole heart” for specific works of justice and mercy you have seen. When oppression seems permanent, hold verse 9–10 and 18. Refuse the pride of nations and institutions that forget they are “but men.” Seek God by name—not as a slogan, but as the refuge who does not forsake.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What marvelous works can you “shew forth” in praise this week (v. 1)?

2. Who around you needs the refuge of verse 9—and how might you reflect that refuge practically?

3. Where do you see the pride of “nations... but men,” and how should that shape your prayers?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).